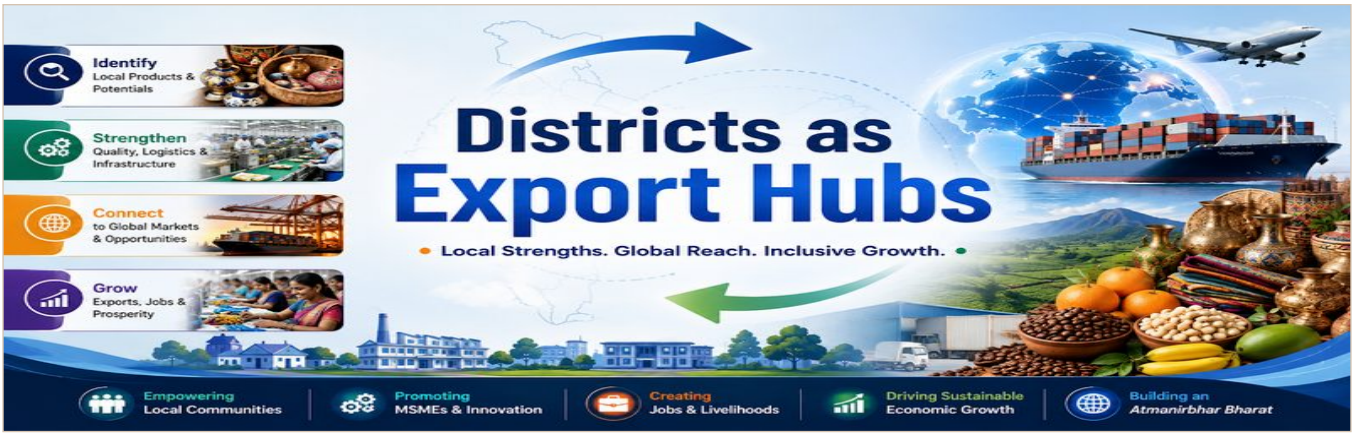


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[GS II - GOVERNANCE | GS III - ECONOMY] | **Publication Date: 02/09/2026**

Districts as Export Hubs



India's Districts as Export Hubs initiative shifts focus from local production to global markets, strengthening MSMEs, exports, employment, competitiveness, and inclusive district-led economic growth.

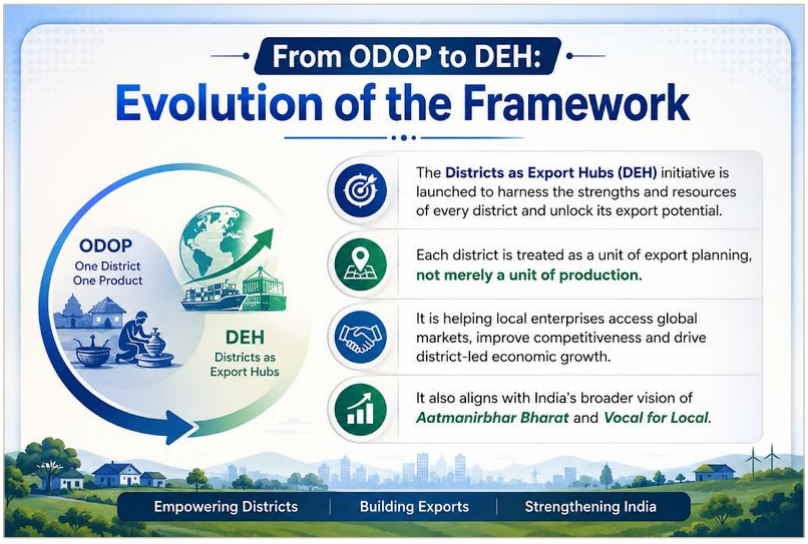
Districts as Export Hubs

Syllabus Areas:

GS II - Governance | GS III - Economy

Watch the Video on District's GDP

India's export growth is entering a new phase—moving beyond traditional industrial centres to unlock the potential of every district, empower local producers, strengthen MSMEs, and integrate them with global markets.



Why India Needed a District-Led Export Model

- Exports have become a key engine of India's growth story. Every rupee earned from overseas markets adds to jobs, incomes and industry at home.
- India's total exports of goods and services touched an all-time high of **US$ 825.25 billion in 2024-25**, growing further to an estimated **US$ 863.11 billion in 2025-26**.
- For decades, export activity stayed concentrated around a handful of established industrial clusters and port cities.
- Small towns, rural districts and remote regions rarely found their way into shipment manifests, even though many held unique, high-quality products.
- Products such as **Bastar's iron craft, Jalgaon's bananas and Meghalaya's Mandarin Oranges** reflected this untapped strength.
- Recognising this opportunity, the Government brought in a **district-led export strategy in the form of Districts as Export Hubs Initiative**, enabling every district to contribute to India's export growth by leveraging its unique strengths.



The story of DEH begins with the **One District One Product (ODOP)** programme. ODOP set out to select, brand and promote **one distinctive product from each district**, converting local identity into economic opportunity.



To strengthen this approach, the **Department of Commerce through the DEH initiative under the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT)** has expanded the focus from product promotion to a **comprehensive export promotion and ecosystem strengthening**. As on January 2026, the DEH initiative covers **more than 770 districts across the country**, reflecting its expanding reach and stronger integration with overall export planning.

Mapping products and services

DEH identifies export-worthy products and services across districts. These include **GI-tagged products, agricultural clusters, and toy clusters, engineering goods etc.** District-specific mapping helps prepare targeted export strategies.

Some of the products with export potential include:

DEH PRODUCTS ACROSS DISTRICTS

PRODUCT	DISTRICT	STATE
Ceramic & Tiles, Potato	Sabarkantha	Gujarat
Minerals, Agro-processing, Glass and Tiles	Aravalli	Gujarat
Jalgaon Banana, Jalgaon Bharit Brinjal	Jalgaon	Maharashtra
Orange	Agar Malwa	Madhya Pradesh
Bastar Iron Craft, Rice, Jowar, Maize	Baster	Chhattisgarh
Bamboo Craft, Cashew	Jamtara	Jharkhand

